

Village Farm Advisory Kiosk

Case Study No. 31 | Go-to-Market & Customer Operations

Problem Statement

- Farmers who are uncomfortable with smartphone apps still need weather, market-price and crop information.
- Without it: missed weather windows, weak mandi bargaining, avoidable crop loss, dependence on middlemen.

Opportunity Statement

- A staffed village kiosk gives assisted digital access in the local language.
- ₹10 per information request; 45 requests/day covers ₹9,000 monthly cost with a surplus of ₹4,500.

Rashmeet Kaur Nanade

Roll No. 150096725165 | B.Tech Computer Science & Engineering, Second Year | Semester III – Sprint I

ITM Skills University

Target Customers

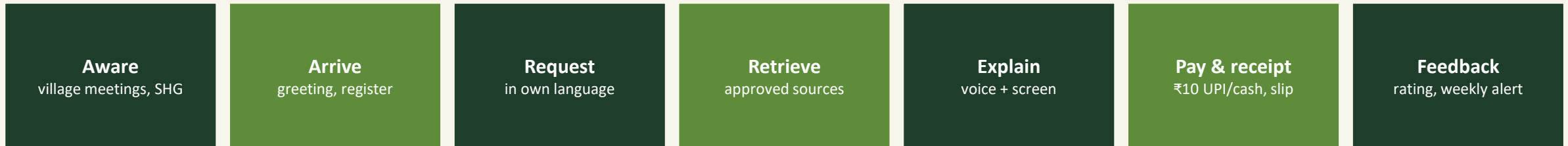
- Small and marginal farmers (40+)
- Women and tenant farmers
- Farmer groups, SHGs, FPOs
- Vegetable and cash-crop growers

Digital-Access Barriers

- Low literacy; English-only interfaces
- Unfamiliar with apps; fear of mistakes
- Weak network, data cost, shared phone
- Low trust in unknown sources

Customer profile: Ramesh, 52, 2 acres, keypad phone, Class 8, sells at mandi 12 km away. Wants rain, price and pest advice from someone he knows.

Value Proposition Canvas	Customer side	Our offer
Jobs	Decide sowing/spraying time, when and where to sell, fix crop problems	Weather, price, crop and scheme information on request
Pains	Cannot use apps; fear of wrong advice; wasted mandi trips; data cost	Operator help in local language; source and time on slip; price check before travel
Gains	Better price, fewer losses, confidence, saved time	Verified, simple, ₹10 per request, voice plus printed slip



Essential Information Categories

- Weather: 3–5 day forecast, rain and storm alerts (IMD)
- Market prices: nearby mandi rates, trend (Agmarknet)
- Crop advice: sowing, dose, pest remedies (KVK, ICAR)
- Schemes: PM-KISAN, crop insurance dates

Trust Model

- Trained local Krishi Sahayak endorsed by panchayat/SHG
- Source and timestamp on every slip
- Weekly expert review of crop advice
- Consent-based data; complaint register; ₹10 refund if unanswered

Two Ways to Encourage Regular Usage

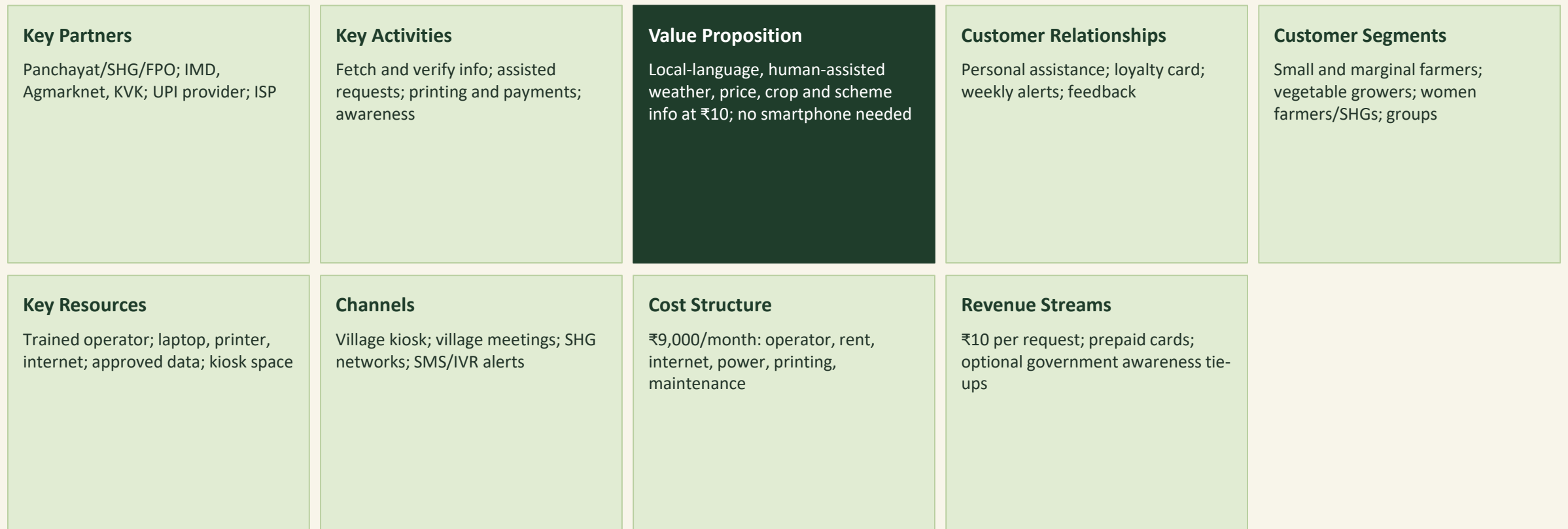
1. Kisan Loyalty Card: prepaid ₹100 = 11 requests (11th free), stamp on every visit.
2. Weekly Market-Day Alert and Crop Clinic: free SMS/voice headline alert plus fixed clinic day inviting farmers for personalised advice.

Supply Chain / Operating Flow and Business Model Canvas

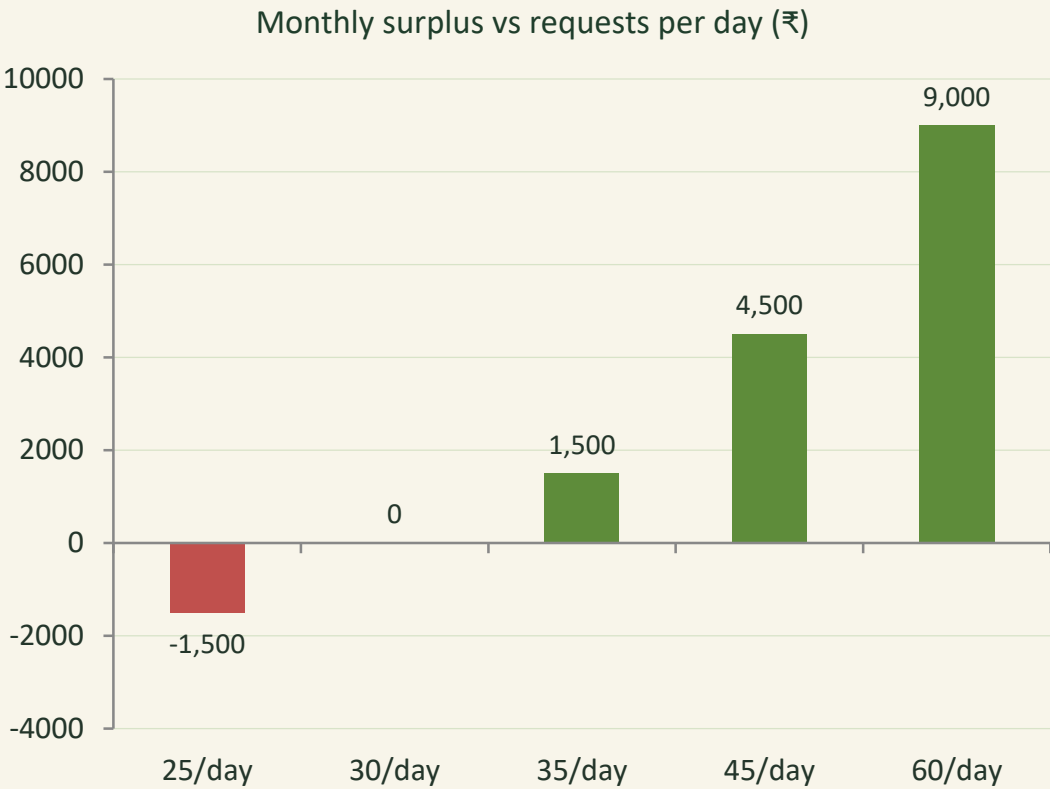
4



Responsibilities: Providers publish data | Operator fetches, verifies, explains, collects cash, logs | Panchayat/SHG gives space and trust | KVK reviews content | Owner funds costs and equipment



Measure	Calculation
Daily revenue	$45 \times ₹10 = ₹450$
Monthly revenue	$1,350 \text{ requests} \times ₹10 = ₹13,500$
Monthly cost	₹9,000 (₹300/day)
Monthly surplus	$₹13,500 - ₹9,000 = ₹4,500$
Break-even	$₹9,000 \div ₹10 = 900/\text{month} = 30/\text{day}$
Margin of safety	$(45 - 30) \div 45 = 33\%$
Cost per request	$₹9,000 \div 1,350 = ₹6.67$
Capacity	~5 min/request, 8 hrs: ~96/day; 45/day ≈ 47% use



Assumptions: 30 operating days; ₹9,000 fixed; free public data. On 26 working days, break-even is ~35 requests/day. Below 30 requests/day the kiosk loses money, so regular usage design is critical.

SWOT

- S: low price, trusted local operator, real need, low fixed cost
- W: internet/power dependence, seasonal demand, small revenue base
- O: replicate in villages, add e-services, KVK/FPO tie-ups
- T: free apps and WhatsApp, wrong information, low trust or footfall

Key Risks and Mitigation

- Wrong information → approved sources, expert review
- Low footfall → loyalty card, alerts, SHG mobilisation
- Internet/power failure → hotspot, power backup, cache
- Operator dependence → training, backup, UPI-first, cash log
- Free app competition → human, local-language trust
- Privacy concerns → consent, no data sale

90-Day Plan and Success Criteria

- Days 1–30 Build: partner, operator, kiosk setup, 100+ farmers surveyed
- Days 31–60 Launch: demos, paid requests, loyalty card; 25+/day, 200 registered, rating above 4/5
- Days 61–90 Scale: weekly alerts and crop clinic; 45/day (30 minimum), 30% repeat users, zero major errors; plan 2–3 villages